

Noah Barlow.

Brand, packaging, and growth leadership for founder-led challenger companies. *Twenty years operating.*

CURRENTLY

Senior advisor · selectively available
Toronto · remote across North America

DIRECT

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20+

years operating

12+

brands launched

300+

packages shipped

\$1B+

portfolios advised

\$8M+

seed capital supported

WHAT I'M HIRED FOR

Three jobs. One operator.

01	Brand strategy and positioning Sharp positioning. Clear point of view. Less deck, more shipping. I translate ambiguous business problems into brand platforms a team can run with — fast.	02	Packaging systems and retail psychology The package is the brand's most-touched media buy. I design pack systems that win the three-second test, signal the right tier, and earn the shelf before the price tag does.	03	Fractional brand & growth leadership Embedded strategic partner for founder-led companies. Senior involvement, limited engagements, close enough to the P&L to be useful to it.
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TRAJECTORY

Two decades, *one through-line*: build the thing.

2017 — NOW

Founder & Senior Operator · *Smaller Agency / Independent Advisory*

Founded Smaller Agency. Now operating as a senior strategic advisor for founder-led challenger brands — brand strategy, packaging systems, and growth leadership delivered as a partner rather than an agency. Selective engagements, senior involvement, no production overhead.

- 12+ brands launched in the Canadian market
 - 300+ packages designed and shipped to retail
 - \$8M+ in seed capital supported via IR + launch leadership
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2019 — 2021

Chief Marketing Officer · *Dosceology Sciences*

Founding CMO of a functional mushroom wellness brand. Built the brand platform, IR deck, website, CRM, packaging, and DTC engine from day one. Owned brand mission, vision, and all customer-facing touchpoints alongside the founder team.

- \$4M+ in funding supported through IR + pitch communications
 - 8 product lines developed (tinctures, powders, supplements)
 - Social audience grown to 10K in year one
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2015 — 2019

VP Marketing · *GreenSpace Brands (ISM)*

Owned brand and marketing across a publicly-traded CPG portfolio of better-for-you food, beverage, and wellness brands distributed nationally across grocery and specialty retail. Led innovation, packaging, partnerships, and integrated marketing across paid, owned, earned, CRM, influencer, and shopper.

- Responsible for \$36M+ in annual brand revenue across 8 CPG brands
 - 6 direct reports across brand, creative, and growth
 - 8 new products with 26 variants launched in year one; 2 master-brand relaunches
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2013 — 2015

Director, Brand & Programming · *Mc&Lewis Ideas*

Led the SABMiller Canada portfolio — Miller Lite, MGD, Grolsch, Pilsner Urquell, Peroni. Directed the Canadian launch of Miller Lite, building the light-beer category in the most competitive segment in Canada from a standing start.

- Grew Toronto office revenue 300% in year one
 - Doubled local client roster without adding overhead
 - Led strategic, creative, and client work across SABMiller Canada
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2011 — 2013

Director, Development & Strategy · *Blueband Digital*

Built early-stage digital agency capabilities for CPG and lifestyle brands when most clients still treated digital as a tactic. Direct client wins included Weetabix, TD, Telus, PlayStation, and Virgin Gaming.

- \$1M+ in net new billings in year one

2009 — 2011

National Manager, Client Development · *Launch (acquired by Mosaic, 2012)*

Built the client portfolio for a national experiential and retail-activation agency — clients included LEGO, Canadian Tire, Beam Global, Carlsberg, PlayStation Canada, Apple, Levi's, and Clif Bar.

→ \$10M+ in net new client billings across the portfolio

2004 — 2008

Account Executive · *Segal Communications*

Consulting and public relations agency. The years that taught me the agency business from the inside — proposals, programs, budgets, and what a client actually pays for.

SELECTED WORK

Brands shipped, repositioned, launched.

Miller Lite Beer · Canadian Launch · SABMiller

Pilsner Urquell Beer · Premium Positioning · SABMiller

Kit Kat Chocolatory Confectionary · Retail · Nestlé

Carlsberg Portfolio Beer · Brand Strategy · Carlsberg Group

MGD Beer · Heritage Strategy · SABMiller

Full case studies at noahbarlow.github.io/work.

PUBLISHED FRAMEWORKS

The thinking on paper.

The Challenger Playbook Whitepaper · 40pp · Smaller Agency

The Modern Brand OS Whitepaper · Smaller Agency

Beer for Gen Z Category whitepaper · Smaller Agency

Gen Z Operating System Whitepaper · Smaller Agency

The Challenger Scorecard Diagnostic companion · Smaller Agency

IN PRINT

Press & features.

Communication Arts Feature · 2020

Strategy Magazine Smaller Agency launch · 2019

Strategy Online Smaller Agency × Grolsch · 2019

Globe & Mail RCLUB feature · 2019

BlogTO, Driving.ca RCLUB launch coverage · 2019

EDUCATION

Foundation.

York University, Toronto BA, Political Science & Communications · 1999–2003
